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Blackhawks stun Scobey

By FRITZ NEIGHBOR
Billings Gazette

Seems like every 30 state tournaments, Seeley-Swan rises up and smacks an unbeaten.

On Thursday, it was time for another — and the Blackhawks rode a pair of timely 3-pointers to a 52-51 overtime upset of top-ranked and defending champion Scobey in the first round of the State C tourney at Metra.

C State

Senior center Jesse Boone scored 17 points and Matt Schneiter added 11 as the 19-6 Blackhawks moved on to Friday's 6:30 p.m. semifinal game against Cascade. The 23-2 Badgers advanced with a 74-53 win over Bridger in Thursday's first game.

Kim Haines, Seeley's head coach for 33 seasons, hasn't had too many wins larger than this. "Absolutely, it's one of the biggest ones I've had," he said afterward. "The last time we beat an unbeaten team at state, it was Bozeman Rosary, by one (61-60) in the semifinals of the 1968 tournament. And it wasn't in overtime."

To get to overtime, Schneiter had to square up from around 27 feet away, and hit a high-arcing 3-pointer to tie the game at 43-all with 19 seconds left in overtime. Scobey (23-1) had a final shot, but standout guard Joel Nieskens ran the clock down before settling for a contested 3-pointer. It was short.

Seeley-Swan's Mike Larson then opened the overtime with another three, putting the Blackhawks ahead for good. Down 49-47 in the final minute, Scobey had two shots to close the gap - but the Blackhawks came up with steals both times.

Seeley's Abe Kats hit two free throws before Scobey's Jason Wolfe hit a 3-pointer to cut the deficit to 51-50 with six seconds left. The Spartans weren't done. They fouled, Schneiter made the first free throw for a 52-50 lead, missed the second, and Scobey's Spencer Frederick rebounded. His ensuing end-to-end drive ended in the Scobey lane, with a foul on Boone with no time left.

That gave Frederick two free throws, but he missed the first, sealing Seeley's win and ending Scobey's win streak at 29. He made the second to cap the scoring.

Both Haines and Scobey coach Dave Selvig agreed that Schneiter's bomb was key. Nieskens had just scored four straight points, including two free throws with 27 seconds left, to put the Spartans up 43-40. Then Schneiter squared up from deep.

"That's the way it goes, I guess," Selvig said. "We wanted to get out on them, but that was from way downtown."

"We kind of got the momentum when Schneiter made that shot," said Haines, whose '68 team went on to claim the state title. "I've got seven guys who can hit threes. Really, eight - my center (Boone) hit one today."

The snow-bound Spartans -who traveled 3 hours by bus, then 80 minutes by plane to reach Billings Thursday - led 23-19 at halftime, but didn't look good doing it.

"We seemed a little flat," Selvig said. "We seemed to get tired, in the first half. I don't know if it was the floor length, or whatever." One answer could be Scobey's travel problems, but Selvig wouldn't say as much. "I'm not going to blame it on that - we knew we had to come to play."

Nieskens scored a game-high 19 points, and Frederick - the 1996 state tournament MVP -added 13. The duo combined to hit just 9 of 31 field goal attempts, however.

Class C pairings

STATE C
At Billings Metra
Thursday

Cascade 74, Bridger 53
Seeley-Swan 52, Scobey 51, OT
Saco 69, Ennis 62
Reedpoint 61, Brady 40

Friday

12:30 p.m. — Bridger (18-7) vs. Scobey (23-1)
2 p.m. — Ennis (21-4) vs. Brady (16-8)
6:30 p.m. — Seeley-Swan (19-6) vs. Cascade (23-2)
8 p.m. — Reedpoint (21-4) vs. Saco (23-1)

Scobey	10	13	10	10	8	– 51
Seeley-Swan	7	12	15	7	9	– 52

SCOBEY (23-1) — Curt Ware 2-5 0-0 4, Spencer Frederick 4-14 5-9 13, Joel Nieskens 5-17 9-10 19, Jason Wolfe 1-9 0-0 3, Jake Petersen 1-4 0-0 3, Cale Handran 2-2 0-1 5, Matt Stenioft 1-1 0-0 2, Jay Hoversland 1-3 0-0 2. Totals 17-55 14-20 51.

SEELEY-SWAN (19-6) — Pat Morin 3-8 2-2 8, Abe Kats 3-5 3-4 9, Jesse Boone 7-14 2-3 17, Matt Schneiter 4-9 2-4 11, Mike Larson 2-8 0-1 5, Leif Ibsen 1-1 0-0 2, Lelan Anders 0-0 0-0 0, Cody Jensen 0-0 0-0 0. Totals 20-46 9-14 52.

3-point goals—Scobey 3-16 (Handran 1-1, Peterson 1-3, Wolfe 1-4), Seeley 3-13 (Boone 1-1, Larson 1-4, Schneiter 1-4). Total fouls—Scobey 15, Seeley 20. Fouled out—Morin. Rebounds—Scobey 30 (Frederick 13, Nieskens 6), Seeley 37 (Schneiter 14, Morin 7). Turnovers—Scobey 11, Seeley 17.

Bridger	13	14	10	16	– 53	
Cascade	32	17	11	14	– 74	

BRIDGER (18-7) — Ryan Stevens 1-4 1-2 3, Clyde Keith 7-24 6-7 24, Spencer Hay 4-6 3-4 11, Brett Zent 5-12 1-2 11, Michael George 1-6 0-0 2, Seth Imlay 0-0 0-0 0, Jeremy Goetz 0-2 0-0 0, Shawn Imlay 0-1 0-0 0, Kasey Keith 1-5 0-0 2. Totals 19-60 11-15 53.

CASCADE (23-2) — Justin Marquis 8-12 0-0 21, Jay Lewis 2-4 1-2 5, Cory Guthmiller 4-5 0-0 8, Tyler Cotton 9-19 6-8 24, Joe Rasmussen 3-13 3-5 10, Derek Lee 0-0 0-0 0, Justin Belote 0-3 1-2 1, Jared Tylinski 0-1 1-2 1, Kristl Iarris 2-2 0-0 4, Bryan Hanes 0-0 0-0 0, James Davis 0-0 0-0 0, Jason Wilham 0-2 0-0 0. Totals 28-61 12-19 74.

3-point goals—Bridger 4-19 (C. Keith 4-12), Cascade 6-13 (Marquis 5-7, Rasmussen 1-5). Total fouls—Bridger 17, Cascade 13. Fouled out—Zent. Rebounds—Bridger 35 (C. Keith 12, Hay 8), Cascade 39 (Lewis 10, Marquis 6). Turnovers—Bridger 19, Cascade 12.

Saco	17	19	18	15	– 69	
Ennis	14	16	19	13	– 62	

SACO (23-1) —Nick Kluck 4-10 0-0 12, Jim Freeman 1-8 3-4 6, Ryan Eklund 5-12 1-4 13, Jason Erickson 3-6 1-3 9, Kris Eklund 1-2 1-3 3, Clint Allen 11-14 4-9 26. Totals: 25-52 10-23 69.

ENNIS (21-4)—Justin Lubke 7-19 0-0 14, Ryan Wright 1-4 0-0 2, David Sportsman 8-15 0-0 19, Gregg Smith 2-9 2-4 6, Zech Lake 0-0 0-0 0, Dustin Tavenner 3-9 2-2 9, Josh Vujovich 4-7 1-1 9, Brandon Brooks 1-6 1-2 3. Totals: 26-69 6-9 62.

3-point goals—Saco 9 (Kluck 4), Ennis 4 (Sportsman 3). Total fouls— Saco 11, Ennis 22. Rebounds—Saco 41 (Allen 14) Ennis 31 (Smith 8). Turnovers—Saco 20, Ennis 13.

Reedpoint	19	16	6	20	– 61	
Brady	14	8	7	11	– 40	

REEDPOINT (21-4)— Justin Ott 4-12 9-10 20, Pat Parker 2-5 2-2 7, Petter Bolander 2-2 0-0 4, Chad Christiansen 0-1 4-4 4, Dan Lutke 9-15 3-4 21, Gabe Whitford 1-1 0-0 2, Shawn Ott 1-1 0-0 3, Gabe Whitford 1-1 0-0 2. Totals 19-37 18-20 61.

BRADY (16-8) — Tucker Bishop 6-21 2-2 15, Casey Copenhaver 3-12 2-2 9, Byron Denzer 3-7 1-2 7, Kurt Thaut 2-8 0-0 4, Daniel Sieler 2-12 0-0 5, Stacey Bucher 0-1 0-0 0, Josh Winterrowd 0-0 0-0 0. Totals 16-61 5-6 40.

3-point goals—Reedpoint 5-14 (J.Ott 3-8, S.Ott 1-1, Parker 1-2, Lutke 0-3), Brady 3-20 (Copenhaver 1-1, Sieler 1-9, Bishop 1-9, Bucher 0-1). Fouled out—Sieler. Total fouls—Reedpoint 8, Brady 29. Rebounds—Reedpoint 38 (J. Ott, Bolander 9), Brady 25.

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